Stablecoin Insider

Q3 | September 2026

MONEY MOVES EAST

The Stablecoin Corridors in Asia in 2026

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STABO Triple-A.

Table of Contents

Executive Summary

1 Why APAC

2 The Regulatory Map

3 The Numbers

4 Who Is Building APAC's Stablecoin Economy

5 Corridor Analysis

6 Key Sectors in APAC Most in Need of Stablecoins

7 Money That Works

8 Outlook 2026–2027

This report draws on first-party data and analysis from five operators, each of which owns a distinct layer of APAC's stablecoin stack. Their data is presented alongside regulator publications, central bank statistics, and independent market research throughout.

Executive Summary

Executive Summary

In the twelve months to September 2026, **Hong Kong** granted its first two stablecoin issuer licences, **Japan** put a trust-bank yen stablecoin into live issuance, **Taiwan** passed a dedicated virtual asset statute, and **Singapore** published the draft legislation that will write its 2023 stablecoin framework into law. No other region has shipped this many named-issuer regimes in a single year.

The structural pull behind that regulatory sprint is enormous. APAC's outbound cross-border payments reached **$13.5 trillion** in 2025 and are projected to grow to $24 trillion by 2035, lifting the region's share of global outbound flows from **31% to 36%** (Source: FXC Intelligence). India and the Philippines remain two of the world's largest remittance recipients. And Asia already originates roughly **60% of the world's genuine stablecoin payment volume**, driven almost entirely by Singapore, Hong Kong, and Japan (Source: McKinsey & Company). **What makes APAC distinct is that regulated stablecoins are arriving as licensed financial infrastructure rather than as workarounds.**

What the report covers & the key players

CAPITAL LAYER

The Taipei-based provider of stablecoin infrastructure for the global AI supply chain, on why Asia's largest export corridor gets built through banks or not at all, the receiving end of AI-era payments, and the operational reality of Taiwan's new Virtual Asset Service Act.

MOVANTIS

The regulated financial infrastructure platform for cross-border value movement across the Americas and beyond, combining payments, remittances, FX & Liquidity, wallet infrastructure, Card Issuing and Processing, stablecoin settlement through one integration, Circle Payments Network member, hybrid fiat-&-stablecoin routing into APAC.

REAP by PAYWARD

The global stablecoin-native financial infrastructure platform that started in Hong Kong being acquired by Kraken's parent for up to $600 million, on corporate spend, the two adoption curves of crypto-native and traditional businesses, and agentic payments.

STABO

The Hong Kong TCSP-structured treasury platform, on B2B collections, custody structures, and the compliance risks that replace chargebacks when merchants accept stablecoins.

Triple-A.

The payment institution licensed in the United States, Europe, and Singapore, on merchant acceptance, stablecoin payouts, treasury flows, and corridor growth out of APAC to Europe and MENA.

Why APAC

The three demand engines, the fragmented FX and banking layer, and why APAC adoption is necessity-driven.

The Regulatory Map

Singapore's MAS Single-Currency Stablecoin Framework, Hong Kong's Stablecoins Ordinance, the HKMA, Japan's Payment Services Act and the three-lane yen stack, Taiwan's Virtual Asset Service Act, the watchlist covering South Korea, Australia, and UAE–APAC flows.

The Numbers

Market sizing, settlement volume across three measures, corridor breakdown by flow type, adoption segmentation, and the funding and M&A snapshot.

Who Is Building APAC's Stablecoin Economy

Trade settlement and the bank connectivity layer, corporate payments through stablecoin-funded cards, merchant acceptance, enterprise treasury from collections to capital deployment, and remittances on the hybrid-rail model.

Corridor Analysis

Intra-APAC (SG ↔ HK ↔ JP and TW ↔ JP ↔ KR), APAC–US, APAC–Middle East, and the high-volume remittance lanes from the US and Gulf into the Philippines, India, and Indonesia.

Key Sectors in APAC Most in Need of Stablecoins

Supply chains and trade settlement, remittances, cross-border e-commerce and digital commerce, and corporate treasury and FX optimisation.

Money That Works

Legacy correspondent banking versus stablecoin rails, what changes on the balance sheet, what does not change, practical entry points by jurisdiction, and the routing principle.

Outlook 2026–2027

Which licences clear next, where multi-currency settlement consolidates, the regulatory arbitrage that closes, and the forward view on agentic payments and B2B automation.

1

Why APAC: The Structural Pull

Why APAC: The Structural Pull

The three demand engines

APAC's stablecoin demand does not rest on one use case. It rests on **three overlapping structural conditions** that legacy payment rails serve poorly.

1. Intra-Asia trade settlement

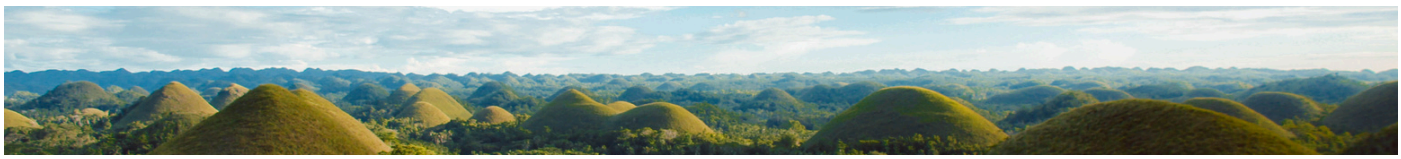
Asia trades with itself more than with anyone else. Intra-regional trade accounted for nearly **60% of the region's total exports** in 2024 (Source: UN ESCAP), and in 2025 it remained a key anchor even as regional export growth slowed to 3.3%; ESCAP projects regional trade growth of around 0.6% in 2026 as firms prioritise supply chain diversification (Source: UN ESCAP).

Those transactions still typically route through correspondent banking chains that take two to five days to settle, accumulate fees at each intermediary and FX hop, and offer no visibility while funds are in transit, according to Capital Layer, a Taipei-based settlement infrastructure provider working with banks across the Taiwan–Japan–Korea corridor (Source: Capital Layer, industry aggregate).

2. The world's largest remittance corridors

India received a record **$135.46 billion in inward remittances in FY2024–25**, up 14% year on year (Source: IBEF / Economic Survey 2025-26). Net private transfers, which mainly comprise remittances, rose to a record $144.8 billion in FY2025–26 from $124.6 billion the year before (Source: The Tribune).

Overseas **Filipinos** sent home a record **$35.63 billion in cash remittances in 2025**, equal to 7.3% of GDP, with the United States accounting for 39.7% of flows, **Singapore 7.3%, Saudi Arabia 6.6%, and the UAE 4.6%** (Source: BusinessWorld). The Philippine central bank forecasts cash remittances of $36.7 billion for 2026 (Source: Manila Bulletin).



3. A deep manufacturing and treasury base

Exporters and manufacturers across **Taiwan**, **Japan**, **Korea**, **Vietnam**, and **Southeast Asia** hold working capital across multiple currencies and settle seven-figure invoices across borders daily. In these corridors the heaviest cost is not the fee but the prepayments and receivables locked in transit for days at a time (Source: Capital Layer, industry aggregate).

The largest and fastest-growing of these flows is the **AI hardware supply chain**. Taiwan accounts for more than **90% of the world's leading-edge chip manufacturing** (Source: U.S. International Trade Administration, Taiwan Country Commercial Guide), and Taiwanese manufacturers assemble the majority of the world's AI servers. Global AI server shipments are forecast to grow nearly 31% in 2026 (Source: TrendForce, 3 August 2026), and global data centre capital expenditure is forecast to pass US$1 trillion in 2026 (Source: Dell'Oro Group, 10 June 2026).

The largest buyers settle these invoices in dollars between treasury teams that barely notice a three-day float. The cost sits further down the chain, with the mid-sized suppliers and contract manufacturers waiting on that float, and in corridors outside the dollar hubs, where local payment rails add high-single-digit fees to every leg. Taiwanese manufacturers selling AI hardware into Latin America are paying **up to 11%** in local real-time payment fees, according to Capital Layer's chief executive (Source: Blockhead)

The fragmented FX and banking layer

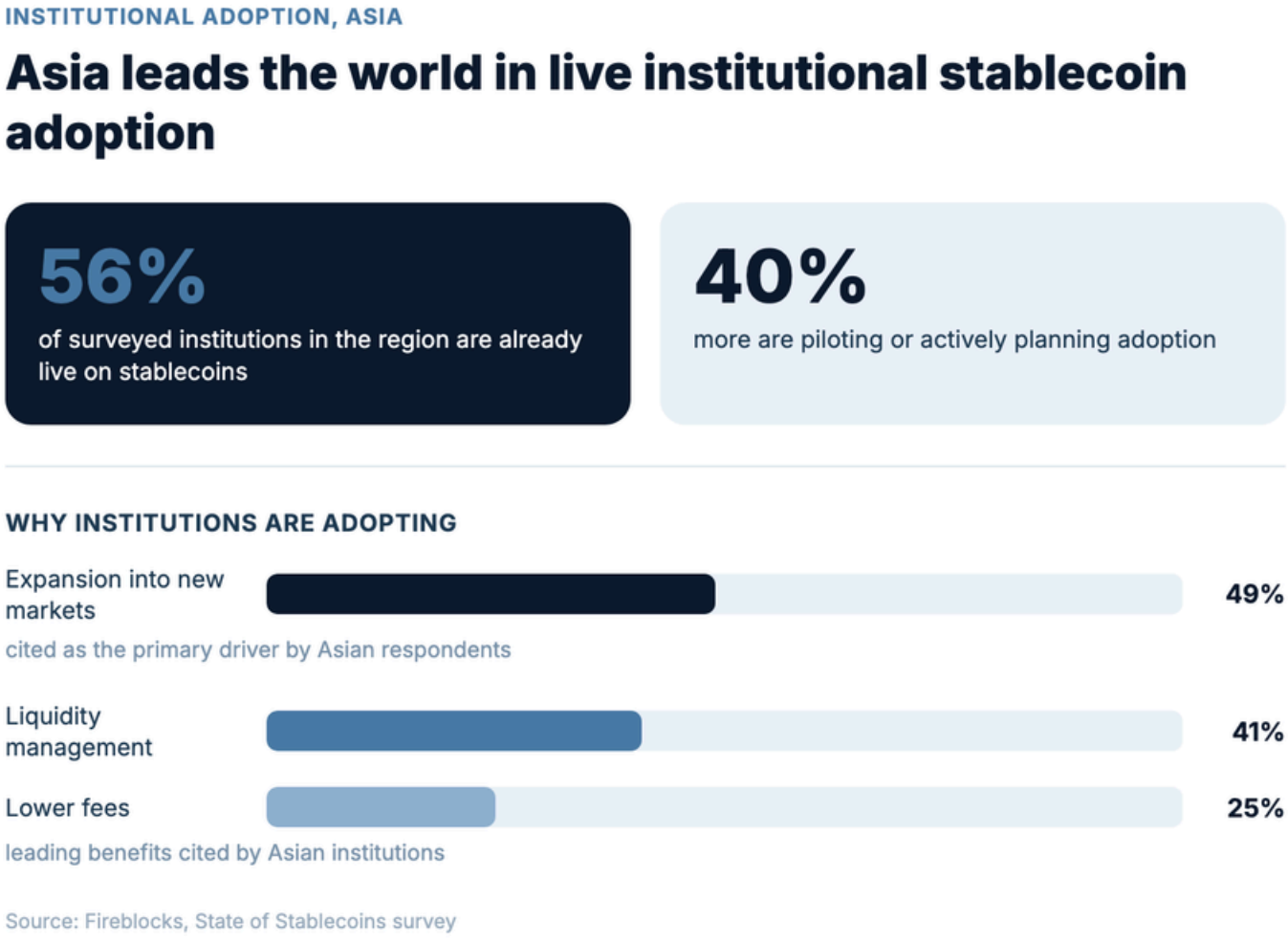
Underneath all three engines sits a **banking layer that is fragmented by design:** more than a dozen major currencies, dozens of regulators, and a correspondent banking network that settles within banking hours, subject to cut-off times and holiday calendars in multiple jurisdictions. When a transaction originates in the United States and lands in Manila or Mumbai across a 12-to-16-hour time difference, that constraint adds a full business day of delay on virtually every payment. For operators running both US origination and APAC payout, that time zone constraint is not an edge case. It applies to virtually every transaction in the corridor (Source: Movantis)

The cost of that fragmentation is visible in remittance pricing. The World Bank's International MTO Index stood at 5.52% in Q3 2025, and the average cost of sending $200 to G20 receiving countries was 5.68% (Source: World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide, Q3 2025). The UN Sustainable Development Goal target remains 3% (Source: UN Statistics Division).

Why APAC adoption is necessity-driven

The contrast with Europe is instructive. **European markets have relatively stable currencies, deep cross-border banking infrastructure through SEPA, and a mature correspondent network.** The pain points that drive stablecoin adoption in emerging markets are largely absent there, so European adoption is driven by efficiency optimization rather than operational necessity. APAC, like Latin America, is driven by necessity, and necessity produces faster and more durable adoption (Source: Movantis).

The institutional data supports this. Fireblocks' State of Stablecoins survey found **Asia leading the world in live institutional adoption**, with 56% of surveyed institutions in the region already live and a further 40% piloting or planning; **49% of Asian respondents cite expansion into new markets as their primary driver**, and liquidity management is the leading benefit cited, at 41%, against 25% citing lower fees (Source: Fireblocks).



Reaching a payout location is easy to claim. Reaching it with regulated settlement on both ends is not.

That distinction is the whole game, and it's why the winning infrastructure is measured by compliance depth, not by how many countries appear on a coverage map.

Gustavo Ruiz,
Chairman & CEO, Movantis

2

The Regulatory Map

The Regulatory Map

APAC is the only region where three separate jurisdictions have shipped live, named-issuer stablecoin regimes, with a fourth passed and awaiting commencement. Each takes a different structural approach.

Singapore: MAS Single-Currency Stablecoin Framework

Singapore finalised its Single-Currency Stablecoin (MAS-SCS) framework in August 2023, applying it to stablecoins pegged to the Singapore dollar or any G10 currency and issued in Singapore (Source: Monetary Authority of Singapore).

On 1 September 2026, MAS published a consultation paper on legislative amendments to the Payment Services Act 2019 to write that framework into law. The consultation closes on 16 October 2026 (Source: Monetary Authority of Singapore). The proposals introduce a **dedicated stablecoin issuance licence, 100% reserve backing, redemption at par, a ban on paying interest or yield to holders, mandatory stress testing, and recovery and wind-down plans** (Source: The Crypto Times).

Two proposals stand out for the corridor economy

1

Joint issuance can carry the label

MAS proposes to allow stablecoins jointly issued by a Singapore issuer and a foreign issuer to carry the "MAS regulated stablecoin" label, provided risks are mitigated.

2

Recognition for foreign issued coins

Recognising cross border wholesale use cases, MAS proposes to recognise a limited number of foreign issued stablecoins regulated under comparable foreign frameworks.

→ This is the first explicit APAC regulatory opening to foreign and multi jurisdiction issuance models.

Sources: TNGlobal, Gibson Dunn

Hong Kong: Stablecoins Ordinance and the HKMA

Hong Kong's Stablecoins Ordinance came into force on 1 August 2025, requiring anyone issuing a fiat-referenced stablecoin in Hong Kong, or issuing an HKD-referenced stablecoin anywhere in the world, to hold an HKMA licence (Source: HSBC). The core requirements are **HK$25 million in paid-up capital, full 1:1 reserve backing in high-quality liquid assets, prompt redemption at par, and Hong Kong substance**; only licensed issuers' stablecoins may be offered to retail investors (Source: Vantegris).

The HKMA received **36 formal applications by the 30 September 2025 deadline**. On 10 April 2026 it granted the first two licences, to Anchorpoint Financial Limited and The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited (Source: Hong Kong Monetary Authority; Fintech Law). Anchorpoint is a joint venture of Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong), HKT, and Animoca Brands (Source: Charltons).

Anchorpoint began the phase-one institutional rollout of HKDAP, its Hong Kong dollar stablecoin, on 12 August 2026, restricted to institutional distributors and professional investors through HashKey Exchange and OSL Group, with retail access targeted for as early as end-2026 (Source: CoinDesk). Standard Chartered subsequently became the first bank to distribute a regulated Hong Kong stablecoin (Source: CoinPaprika). HSBC plans to launch its own HKD stablecoin in the second half of 2026, integrated into PayMe and the HSBC HK App (Source: HSBC).

→ Anyone issuing a fiat referenced stablecoin in Hong Kong, or issuing an HKD referenced stablecoin anywhere in the world, must hold an HKMA licence.

CORE LICENCE REQUIREMENTS

HK$25M
Minimum paid up capital

1:1
Full reserve backing in high quality liquid assets

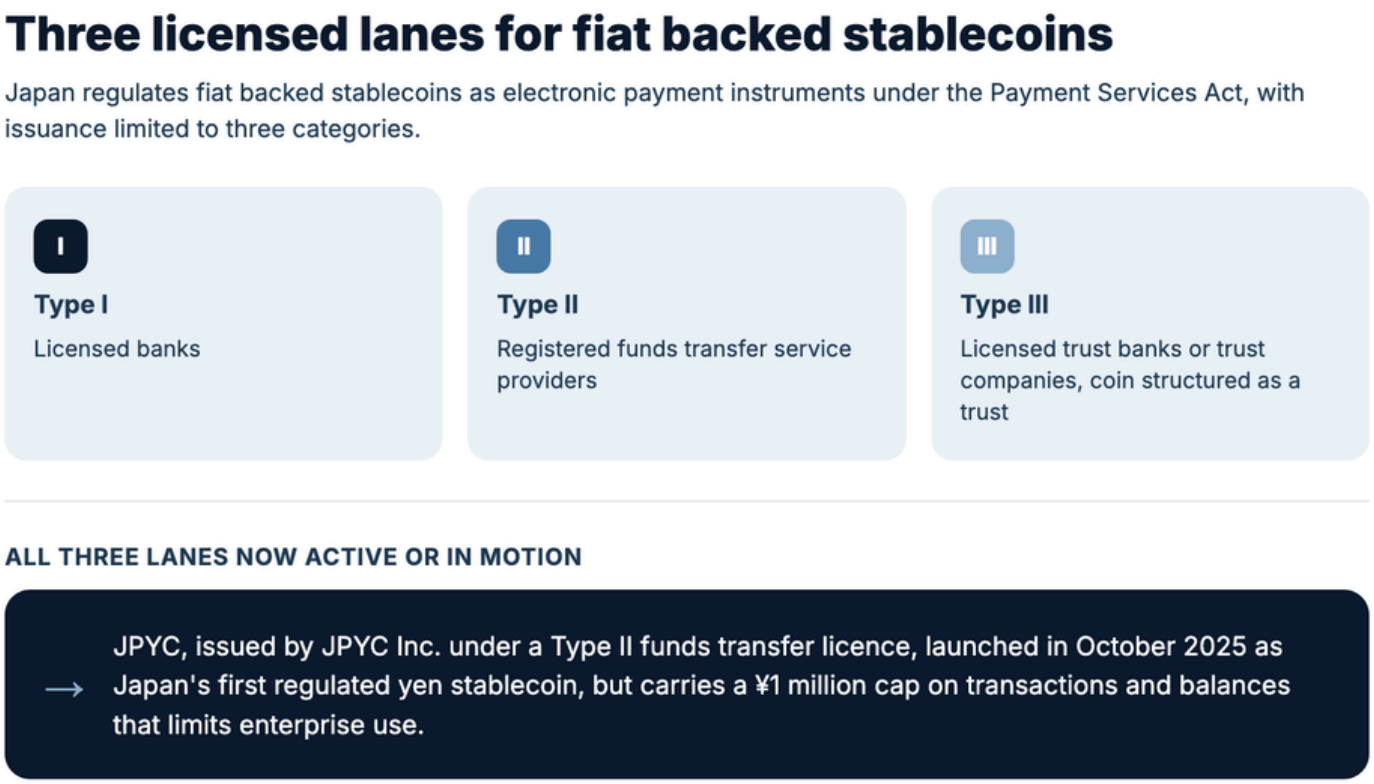
At par
Prompt redemption for holders

Local
Hong Kong substance requirement

Japan: Payment Services Act and the three-lane yen stack

Japan regulates fiat-backed stablecoins as electronic payment instruments under the Payment Services Act. Issuance is limited to three categories: **Type I** (licensed banks), **Type II** (registered funds-transfer service providers), and **Type III** (licensed trust banks or trust companies, where the coin is structured as a trust) (Source: Coin Gabbar).
Japan now has all three lanes active or in motion. JPYC, issued by JPYC Inc. under a Type II funds-transfer licence, launched in October 2025 as Japan's first regulated yen stablecoin, but carries a ¥1 million cap on transactions and balances that limits enterprise use (Source: Fystack).

JPYSC, issued by SBI Shinsei Trust Bank and co-developed with Startale Group, **launched on 24 June 2026 as Japan's first Type III trust-bank yen stablecoin**, carrying no transaction cap and giving holders beneficial interests in segregated trust reserves (Source: Digital Today). And MUFG, Mizuho, and SMBC have established a joint council to co-issue a yen stablecoin under a trust agreement by the end of Japan's fiscal year 2026, in March 2027 (Source: Cryptonews via Yahoo Finance).
The megabanks' Project Pax proof of concept **targets ¥1 trillion in B2B stablecoin issuance by 2028 across more than 300,000 corporate clients** (Source: Fystack).



Taiwan: Virtual Asset Service Act

Taiwan's Legislative Yuan passed the Virtual Asset Service Act on 30 June 2026, moving the island from AML registration to a full licensing regime across seven categories of virtual asset service provider (Source: Focus Taiwan).

Stablecoin issuance requires approval from both the Financial Supervisory Commission and the central bank, 100% reserves held in trust, redemption at face value, and a prohibition on paying yield; the Act and its nine subordinate regulations are expected to take effect together in the first quarter of 2027 at the earliest (Source: TRM Labs).
Unlicensed operation carries up to seven years' imprisonment (Source: Yahoo Finance). Of Taiwan's 38 banks, 18 to 20 have signalled to the FSC that they intend to offer stablecoin services, according to Capital Layer's chief executive (Source: Blockhead).

Structurally, **Taiwan lands closest to Japan's PSA model**: bank-system-anchored, issuer-restrictive, and built for institutional participants rather than retail trading. **It is more conservative than Singapore's framework on issuance**, with dual-regulator approval, and like Hong Kong's Ordinance it criminalises unlicensed activity. With Japan's regime live and Taiwan's framework passed, it is one of the **first corridors with a live regime on one end and a passed statute on the other** (Source: Capital Layer).

The watchlist: South Korea, Australia, and UAE

South Korea

Won-denominated trades accounted for 30% of all global spot cryptocurrency volume in 2026 to date, second only to the US dollar (Source: Tech Times). Yet a won stablecoin remains blocked by a dispute between the Bank of Korea, which wants issuance limited to bank-led consortia with 51% bank ownership, and the Financial Services Commission, which argues that rule would suppress innovation (Source: CoinDesk).

On 29 July 2026 the FSC said it is preparing a government-backed Digital Asset Basic Act that would consolidate ten pending crypto and stablecoin bills into one framework, targeting passage in the second half of 2026 (Source: Coinpedia).

The Act takes effect in the first quarter of 2027, and existing operators have until 2029 to be licensed. That is the window.

The settlement layer for Asia's largest export corridor gets decided inside it, and it gets decided inside banks. Licensing opens the door.

Whether a bank can receive, screen, and account for a stablecoin payment inside systems its auditors already trust is what decides who walks through it.

Justin Wang,
CEO, Capital Layer

Australia

Australia passed the Corporations Amendment (Digital Assets Framework) Bill on 1 April 2026, requiring crypto exchanges and custody providers to obtain an Australian Financial Services Licence (Source: Law Society Journal). Payment stablecoins are being treated separately, as "tokenised stored-value facilities" under ASIC oversight, with APRA stepping in for major issuers above a $200 million threshold (Source: Chainalysis).

Two AUD stablecoins are already live under AFSL coverage. AUDM, issued by Macropod, launched in October 2025 after ASIC granted Australia's first standalone stablecoin licence in September 2025; it is issued 1:1 against Australian dollars held in segregated trust accounts at one of the Big Four banks (Source: Milysec), is a participant in the Reserve Bank's Project Acacia, and is listed on major domestic exchanges (Source: Chainalysis). AUDD, issued by Novatti-backed AUDC Pty Ltd, received its own AFSL from ASIC on 10 February 2026 to provide regulated non-cash payment facilities, removing a key regulatory hurdle for Tier-1 banks and asset managers to hold or trade AUD-backed digital assets (Source: TipRanks / Novatti ASX announcement). AUDD operates across Ethereum, Stellar, XRP Ledger, Solana, Hedera, XDC Network, Base, and Redbelly Network, became the first AUD-backed stablecoin listed on Coinbase's global retail platform in September 2025, and surpassed $1.4 billion in payments volume on Stellar in January 2026 (Source: Australian FinTech).

The gap is at the bank layer. AUDC's chief executive has described the exchange-licensing regime, combined with interim AFSL arrangements, as a pathway into stablecoin regulation that remains incomplete, with banks needing greater regulatory certainty before they come on board (Source: Capital Brief). For APAC corridors, Australia therefore has licensed AUD coins on multiple public chains but no dedicated issuer

As the regulated issuer of AUDD in Australia and issuer of NZDSC in New Zealand, **we have a unique view across both markets**.

We're seeing stablecoin adoption move beyond just proving the technology works to delivering real economic utility. In **Australia**, stablecoins are increasingly becoming part of the infrastructure for payments, settlement and tokenised markets.

New Zealand is at an earlier stage, but as a small, trade-dependent economy it has an especially compelling opportunity to use this technology to reduce the cost and friction of moving money internationally.

The next phase of adoption in both markets will be driven less by speculation and more by businesses using stablecoins because they provide a genuinely better way to move and settle value.

Effie Dimitropoulos,
CEO & Co-Founder, AUDC and Regulated issuer of AUDD and issuer of NZDSC

United Arab Emirates

The Gulf is one of APAC's largest remittance sources, accounting for 11.2% of Philippine cash remittances in 2025 through Saudi Arabia and the UAE alone (Source: BusinessWorld), and employing nearly half of all Indian migrants (Source: INDIA New England News). What changed in 2026 is that the UAE end of those corridors now has its own regulated dirham stablecoins.

Under the Central Bank of the UAE's Payment Token Services Regulation, payments for goods and services on the UAE mainland may only be made with CBUAE-approved payment tokens, in practice dirham payment tokens backed one-to-one by dirhams in segregated, audited reserves; foreign-currency stablecoins are confined to virtual-asset purchases and the financial free zones' own regimes (Source: Neo Legal). AED-referenced tokens including AE Coin, Zand AED, RAKBANK's dirham stablecoin, and the IHC-led DDSC have received approvals, USDU is registered as the first foreign payment token, and ADGM's FSRA operates a separate Fiat-Referenced Token framework under which Paxos Issuance MENA and Universal Digital are licensed to issue USD-backed stablecoins (Source: Chambers and Partners).

The two live dirham coins take different routes to APAC relevance. **DDSC** was approved by the CBUAE to go live on 11 February 2026. Initiated by International Holding Company and First Abu Dhabi Bank with Sirius International Holding, it runs on ADI Chain, an institutional Layer-2 developed by the Abu Dhabi-based ADI Foundation, and targets institutional and government-led use cases including payments and collections, high-value settlement and treasury operations, and trade and supply-chain flows (Source: The Paypers).

United Arab Emirates

In May 2026 IHC executed a single AED 110 million DDSC transaction on ADI Chain, and IHC reports more than AED 150 million processed since launch (Source: Bitget News). In July 2026 DDSC received CBUAE approval to be distributed through selected exchanges regulated by Dubai's Virtual Assets Regulatory Authority, extending it from institutional settlement toward retail and merchant payments (Source: Ledger Insights). The ADI Foundation's stated roadmap is to prove the model with the dirham, extend to other GCC currencies, connect to Africa via M-Pesa infrastructure, and enable interoperable settlement across MENA, Africa, and Asia (Source: Decrypt). That roadmap is the explicit Gulf-to-Asia settlement thesis.

AE Coin, issued by Al Maryah Community Bank, received final regulatory approval in October 2024 and was used by Dubai's Department of Finance in an October 2025 pilot of crypto payments for government services (Source: Bitcoin Ethereum News). In January 2026 Network International became the first payments platform in the UAE to enable regulated stablecoin payments at scale through AE Coin, integrating it into point-of-sale and e-commerce systems so merchants can accept it across physical and digital channels (Source: Gulf News). That is the merchant-acceptance layer that a Gulf-based worker or business paying an APAC counterparty would touch first.

The bank-issuer wave is following. RAKBANK received in-principle approval from the CBUAE on 7 January 2026 to issue a dirham-backed payment token, fully backed 1:1 by dirhams in segregated regulated accounts with audited smart contracts and real-time reserve attestations (Source: Cointelegraph). Zand Bank received full approval in November 2025 to launch Zand AED, the country's first regulated multi-chain AED stablecoin on public blockchains (Source: Bitcoin Ethereum News).

For the APAC corridor economy, the significance is structural. The UAE now has a licensed dirham settlement asset on the sending end and Singapore, Hong Kong, and Japan have licensed coins on the receiving end, which makes Gulf-to-APAC the first cross-regional pairing where both sides can settle in regulated local-currency stablecoins.

The commercial demand is already visible: **Triple-A's APAC-to-MENA flows grew 604% in 2025, the fastest-growing corridor in its network** (Source: Triple-A). What remains missing is the bridge itself: no dirham coin is yet recognised under MAS, HKMA, or Japanese rules, and no APAC coin is an approved foreign payment token in the UAE. The UAE regime is therefore a corridor counterpart rather than a domestic APAC licence, but it is now a fully regulated one.

What "licensed" actually unlocks

Licensing in APAC unlocks four distinct capabilities, and different operators hold different combinations.

1. **Issuance and public offering of a named fiat-referenced coin:** the HKMA FRS licence, the MAS-regulated SCS label, and Japan's electronic payment instrument classification.
2. **Bank distribution:** Standard Chartered distributing HKDAP is the first live example.
3. **Custody and trust structures:** Japan's trust-bank lane is the cleanest statutory "trust stablecoin." In Hong Kong, STABO's Trust or Company Service Provider (TCSP) structure allows it to support trust and asset-segregation arrangements for clients through STABO Trust (Source: STABO).
4. **Payments and on/off-ramp licences** that let firms run merchant acceptance, cards, and payouts without being the issuer.

Triple-A is licensed in the United States, Europe, and Singapore (Source: Triple-A). **Reap** holds Visa Principal Issuer membership in both Hong Kong and Mexico (Source: Reap). **Movantis** holds more than 60 licences across the Americas through its regulated subsidiaries (Source: Movantis), operating as licensed originator in the US and payout operator across 15+ Latin American markets, with 90,000+ payout locations and 50+ MTO relationships built over 20 years.

A member of the Circle Payments Network, Movantis routes each transaction through the optimal rail per payment, combining fiat and stablecoin settlement under one compliance standard.(Source: PR Newswire). **STABO** holds a US MSB registration alongside its Hong Kong TCSP, with a Canadian MSB registration in progress (Source: STABO).

What licensing does not yet unlock is passporting. There is no mutual recognition among Singapore, Hong Kong, and Japan. MAS's September 2026 proposal to recognise foreign-issued stablecoins is the first crack in that wall.

3

The Numbers

The Numbers

Market sizing

The total stablecoin market capitalisation stood at $308.0 billion on 13 August 2026, up 14.3% year on year from $269.4 billion in August 2025, roughly 99.5% dollar-denominated, and about 4.5% below its May 2026 peak (Source: Reap, citing DefiLlama). Total capitalisation peaked near $320 billion in May 2026 before settling in the $300–310 billion range through late August (Source: Crypto Briefing). An estimated 269 million on-chain addresses held a stablecoin balance as of mid-2026 (Source: Reap, citing rwa.xyz).

$308.0B
total market cap on 13 August 2026, up 14.3% year on year from $269.4B

99.5%
dollar denominated

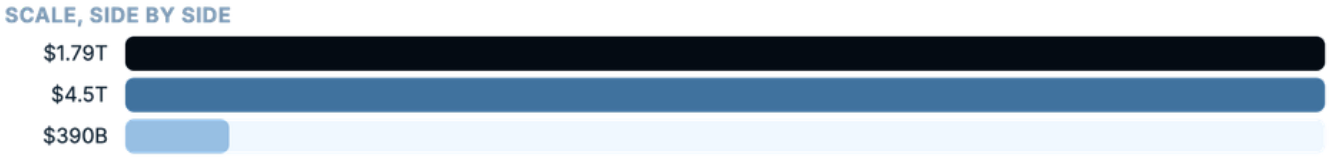
269M
on chain addresses held a balance, mid 2026

Peaked near $320B in May 2026, about 4.5% above the August level, then settled in the $300 to 310B range through late August.

The notable feature of 2026 is decoupling. **Stablecoin supply fell more than 30% in the last crypto bear market but has held near record highs through the 2026 downturn** (Source: Reap). Stablecoins are behaving like payment infrastructure, not like a crypto proxy.

Settlement volume: three measures, three answers

Stablecoin volume figures vary by an order of magnitude depending on what is being counted.



Same year, three lenses: raw on chain flow, tracked payment volume, and genuine end user spend.

Adjusted on-chain volume

Visa's Onchain Analytics dashboard recorded a record **$1.79 trillion in adjusted stablecoin transaction volume in June 2026**, up 63% month on month and 125% year on year, with USDC accounting for 67%; cumulative adjusted volume over the trailing twelve months reached approximately $10.2 trillion (Source: Crypto Briefing). Adjusted volume strips out bot-driven activity but still includes trading and treasury transfers.

Quarterly payments-tracker volume

Stablecoin volume reached roughly **$4.5 trillion in Q1 2026,** and nearly two-thirds of it originated from Asia, primarily Singapore, Hong Kong, and Japan; North America accounted for roughly a quarter and Europe about 13% (Source: a16z crypto).

Genuine end-user payments

The strictest measure isolates transactions where stablecoins function as money. On that basis, annualised stablecoin payment volume was approximately **$390 billion as of December 2025**, or 0.02% of global payments. B2B payments dominated at about $226 billion, roughly 60% of the total, having grown 733% year on year. Payments sent from **Asia accounted for about $245 billion**, 60% of the global total, driven almost entirely by Singapore, Hong Kong, and Japan; North America was next at $95 billion, followed by Europe at $50 billion. Stablecoin-linked card spending reached $4.5 billion in 2025, up 673% (Source: McKinsey & Company).

The **gap between $10 trillion and $390 billion is the single most important number in this report.** It is the difference between money moving and money paying. Asia leads on both, but the payments figure is where the corridor opportunity lives.

Corridor breakdown by flow type

Operator-level data fills in where public data stops.

APAC to Europe and MENA (merchant and B2B flows): Triple-A's APAC-origin flows to Europe grew 205% in 2025, while flows from APAC to MENA rose 604%, with strong growth continuing across key corridors in 2026 (Source: Triple-A).

Intra-APAC merchant acceptance: Within Triple-A's APAC checkout activity, Singapore, Hong Kong, South Korea, Indonesia, Vietnam, and Thailand are currently among the strongest markets (Source: Triple-A).

Emerging-market retail rails: Tron's stablecoin supply hit a record $89.2 billion in Q2 2026, and the network processed $2.1 trillion in USDT transfers during the quarter, most of it small-value transfers in emerging markets across Southeast Asia, Africa, and Latin America (Source: Crypto Briefing).

Adoption segmentation

Retail and grassroots

An estimated 327 million people in Asia hold or use digital currencies, roughly half of digital currency holders globally, with the strongest adoption in Vietnam, the Philippines, Singapore, and Indonesia, where usage extends beyond ownership into P2P transfers, cross-border payments, remote-work income, and online commerce (Source: Triple-A).

B2B and payments

This is the $226 billion layer: merchant checkout, corporate cards, and supplier settlement. Stablecoin-linked card spending globally reached roughly $18 billion annualised in late 2025 and early 2026 (Source: Reap).

Institutional

Bank-issued HKDAP in Hong Kong, trust-bank JPYSC and the megabank council in Japan, and Taiwan's bank-anchored regime mark the institutional tier.

Funding and M&A snapshot

Capital is consolidating around licensed operators. **Payward**, the parent of Kraken, **agreed on 7 May 2026 to acquire Hong Kong-based Reap Technologies for up to $600 million in cash and stock, its first infrastructure deal in Asia and third-largest acquisition overall** (Source: The Block). Reap nearly tripled revenue and volumes in 2025 and will continue to operate as a standalone platform under its current leadership (Source: Bitcoin.com; Fintech Hong Kong).

Startale Group, co-developer of JPYSC, closed a $63 million Series A in March 2026 led by SBI with Sony participating (Source: Bitcoin.com). JPYC completed two Series B closes totalling approximately ¥4.6 billion, with an investor base dominated by corporate Japan rather than crypto-native funds (Source: Fystack).

4

Who Is Building APAC's Stablecoin Economy

Who Is Building APAC's Stablecoin Economy

APAC's stablecoin economy is **use-case led.** Distinct operators own specific layers of the stack, each anchored to a use case.

Layer	Use case	Operator	Regulatory footprint
Bank connectivity and settlement orchestration	Trade settlement, institutional treasury (TW/ JP/KR)	CAPITAL LAYER	Bank facing technology provider; no licence required
Stablecoin native cards and corporate spend	Corporate payments, T&E, supplier payments, agentic commerce	REAP by PAYWARD	Hong Kong: Money Services Operator (MSO) Mexico: Money Transmitter License, Vulnerable Activities Registration (virtual assets), Vulnerable Activities Registration (credit cards issuing) Visa Principal Issuer Member in Hong Kong and Mexico
Merchant acceptance, payouts and treasury	Cross border trade, e commerce, travel, gaming, marketplaces acceptance, B2B collections, mass payouts	Triple-A.	Payment institution licences in US, EU, Singapore
Treasury and collections platform	B2B collections, payments, capital deployment	STABO	Hong Kong TCSP, US MSB; Canada MSB in progress
Regulated financial infrastructure and multi rail settlement	Remittances, cross border payments, B2B value movement, embedded finance, MTO settlement	MOVANTIS	60+ licences across the Americas through regulated subsidiaries; 90,000+ payout locations; Circle Payments Network member (OFI in US, BFI across 15+ LatAm markets)
HKD issuance	Institutional settlement, treasury	**Anchorpoint (HKDAP), HSBC**	HKMA licensed
JPY issuance	Retail (JPYC), institutional (JPYSC), megabank B2B	**JPYC Inc., SBI Shinsei Trust Bank, MUFG/ SMBC/Mizuho**	Japan PSA Types II and III

Trade settlement: the bank connectivity layer

The stablecoin infrastructure stack has been built almost entirely outside traditional banking, which creates a structural problem: **it is architecturally incompatible with the legacy core systems most banks run.** Integrating the two requires a dedicated translation layer, a category a16z calls "bank connectivity," comprising companies that let banks offer stablecoin capabilities alongside existing systems without a full system transplant (Source: a16z crypto).

Capital Layer's position is that Asia's slot in this category remains unfilled, and that most corridor infrastructure answers how value moves while Capital Layer answers how institutions govern it (Source: Capital Layer). Its **Digital Asset Stacks platform synchronises custody, compliance screening, and settlement coordination** so a bank operates the entire stablecoin flow inside systems its risk and audit teams already govern, while the corporate customer on the receiving end sees funds arrive in an ordinary account. Keys and assets stay inside the bank's own on-premise environment under the bank's control; the bank is the custodian of record and Capital Layer supplies the technology, not the custody. (Source: Capital Layer).

The illustrative use case is a workflow Capital Layer and Taiwanese bank O-Bank (2897-TW) presented at the Stablecoin Summit in Taipei on 8 July 2026, Taiwan's first public stablecoin event following passage of the Virtual Asset Service Act. Run in a fully simulated test environment with no real funds, the demonstration showed a yen-stablecoin payment from a Japanese institution being received by O-Bank and settled to fiat inside the bank's existing risk and compliance controls, with an audit-ready record. O-Bank was the first bank to complete this simulated test with Capital Layer. (Source: PYMNTS).

Capital Layer describes its work as a sequence rather than a product list. **The bank comes first, because the bank is the party that turns a virtual asset into real money**; that layer was demonstrated with O-Bank in full simulation. The enterprise comes next: the exporter, brand vendor, or contract manufacturer whose receivable is the corridor, obtaining stablecoin settlement through its own bank rather than through a new provider.

The endpoint comes last: a machine that ships with a payment identity bound to an account at a regulated bank, receiving and paying inside limits its owner set and the bank approved. Each layer is the precondition for the next, and none of them exists without the bank (Source: Capital Layer).

The scenario modelled JPYSC (Source: Capital Layer). Capital Layer has since announced a partnership with Tokyo-listed Green Monster Inc. (TSE: 157A) covering Taiwan–Japan stablecoin cross-border settlement research in Japan. (Source: Capital Layer), and a distribution partnership with Stark Technology (TWSE: 2480), Taiwan's largest domestic system integrator, to bring its settlement infrastructure to banks across Taiwan (Source: PYMNTS).

"The advantage in Asia's regulated stablecoin markets won't go to whoever settles fastest. It will go to institutions that can run these flows through their own audit and control systems, localized to their regulators, governed inside their existing environment, and built to scale from one corridor to many. That foundation, not speed, is the starting point." says Justin Wang, CEO, Capital Layer

Corporate payments: stablecoin-funded cards

Reap's data shows two distinct adoption curves. Crypto-native and digital-first businesses ramp fast and become high-frequency users early, using stablecoin-linked cards to turn stablecoin treasury into everyday spend without first routing it through a bank account; usage skews toward frequent, smaller transactions such as subscriptions, cloud infrastructure, and vendor payments. For this segment, the card is a faster version of something they were already doing manually. Traditional SMEs and enterprises adopt more gradually. The stablecoin funding mechanism is largely invisible to them; finance teams care about settlement speed and FX savings, not the rail underneath.

Adoption typically starts with cross-border supplier payments or T&E for regional teams, with the card sitting alongside existing corporate card programmes rather than replacing them, and transactions are larger but less frequent and run through procurement and finance approval cycles (Source: Reap).

We started in Asia because the region gave us the right conditions to build. Asia's economic diversity, spanning multiple socioeconomic classes and stages of development, let us design financial products suited to very different needs, and the region's technology infrastructure gave us a strong foundation to build on. With more than 70 million MSMEs across the region, and Asia-Pacific already the world's largest crypto market at $2.36 trillion in transactions, this is where stablecoin infrastructure was always going to take shape first.

Card issuing is where that infrastructure found its first real-world use case at scale. Before stablecoins were being discussed as infrastructure, card issuing was already proving the model, powering B2B payments that needed to move fast and across borders without the friction of traditional rails. That gave stablecoins their earliest validation, not as a speculative asset, but as the plumbing behind real commercial transactions.

Agentic payments are really the next frontier. When agents begin initiating and coordinating transactions at scale, stablecoin rails will likely become the default infrastructure layer for those new payment flows and eventually the architecture of global financial systems.

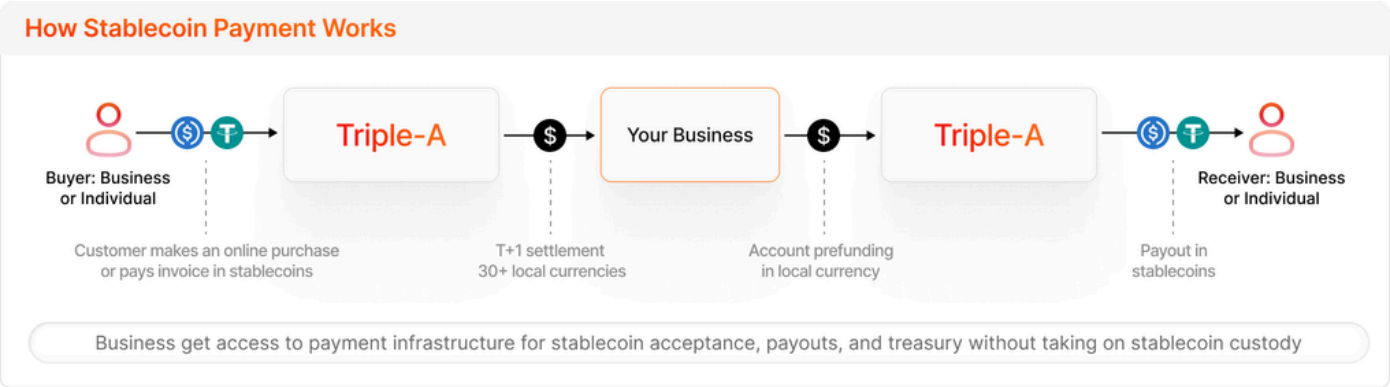
Daren Guo,
Co-Founder, Reap

Merchant acceptance: checkout and b2b payments without custody

Stablecoin acceptance in APAC is increasingly used across two core payment flows: **consumer-to-business payments at checkout and business-to-business payments such as invoices and payment links.**The strongest use cases are typically found in sectors with international customers and high cross-border payment volumes, including travel, e-commerce, digital commerce, gaming, digital services, and financial platforms.

For consumer payments, **stablecoins can be offered alongside existing payment methods at checkout.** For B2B payments, **businesses can accept stablecoins from customers, partners or counterparties for invoices and other cross-border commercial payments.** In both cases, the merchant does not need to hold or manage stablecoins itself: the payment provider can handle conversion, compliance and settlement, while the merchant receives funds in its preferred local currency.

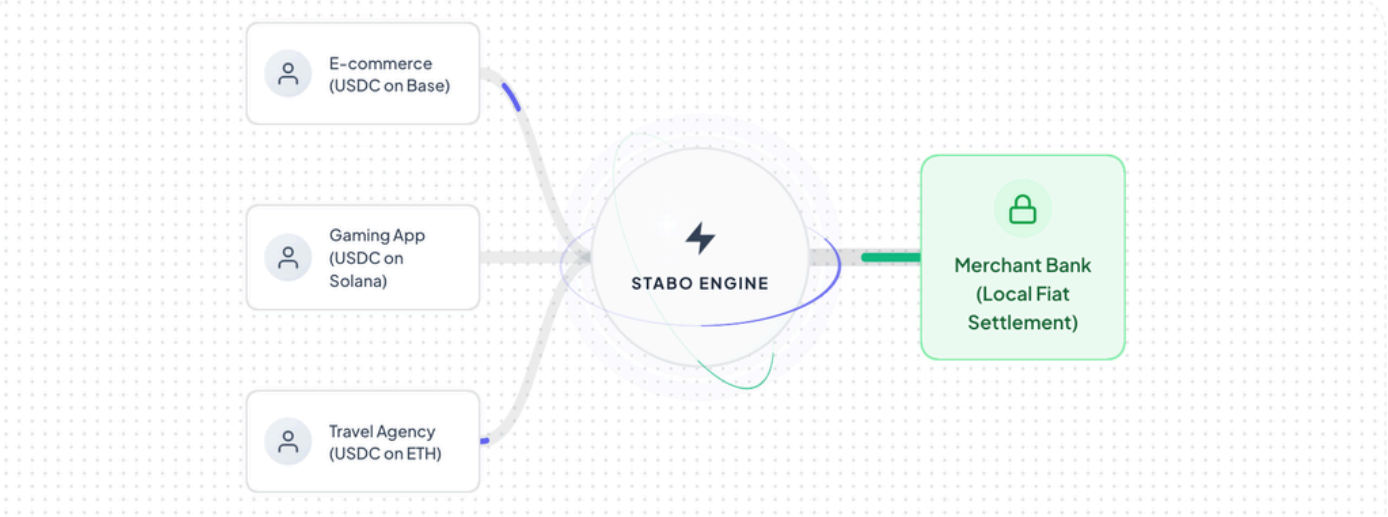
For Triple-A merchants, the commercial case includes reaching customers and counterparties who already hold digital currencies, reducing payment costs and removing card-style chargebacks. In some geographies and segments, particularly gaming, digital goods and cross-border acceptance from markets such as Africa, **stablecoin checkout can represent 15–20% of the total payment volume processed by a merchant.** However, adoption significantly varies by merchant, geography and use case.



Across Triple-A's broader merchant base, clients have achieved up to **70% lower payment costs while eliminating card-style chargebacks**, and in APAC its partner merchants have saved more than US$1.5 million in chargeback costs (Source: Triple-A). Triple-A serves more than 1,000 enterprise customers worldwide (Source: Finextra).

STABO sees a similar adoption pattern. For its APAC-facing clients, the most important adoption pattern is not a large-scale migration of existing card volume into stablecoins. The value is that the merchant can now accept payment from customers or markets where card acceptance, banking access, or cross-border settlement was previously difficult, expanding the addressable market and generating incremental revenue.

Chargeback reduction is a secondary benefit; merchants generally do not change an entire payment stack purely to reduce card chargebacks. **Stablecoin payments remove the card-scheme chargeback mechanism but introduce a different set of risks around wallet provenance and potentially illicit-source funds**, which is why STABO's collection infrastructure includes on-chain KYT, wallet screening, transaction monitoring, and procedures for handling or returning payments (Source: STABO).



The same principle applies to Triple-A, where compliance, wallet screening, transaction monitoring and risk controls are embedded into the payment infrastructure, allowing merchants to accept stablecoin payments without having to manage these processes themselves.

Taken together, these use cases show that the merchant value proposition goes beyond replacing existing card payments. Stablecoin acceptance can open access to new customers and counterparties, improve the economics of cross-border transactions and reduce settlement friction, while regulated payment infrastructure handles the conversion and compliance layer required to connect stablecoin payments with existing fiat operations.

APAC has moved beyond simply being a high-adoption digital currency market. We are now seeing stablecoins used as real cross-border payment infrastructure.

Triple-A's APAC-origin flows to Europe grew 205% in 2025, while flows from APAC to MENA rose 604%, with strong growth continuing across key corridors in 2026.

This points to a broader shift: businesses are increasingly choosing stablecoins where traditional cross-border payments create the most friction.

Eric Barbier,
CEO, Triple-A

Enterprise treasury

STABO is building a treasury suite that spans multiple financial activities, not only payments and stablecoin settlement but, over time, financing and investment. Its Hong Kong TCSP structure supports trust and asset-segregation arrangements through STABO Trust, its US MSB registration establishes the federal BSA/AML framework for money transmission involving fiat and convertible virtual currencies, and its Canadian MSB registration is in progress, which will strengthen connectivity between APAC businesses and North America.

In Hong Kong, financing activities may require money-lending permissions, while investment and virtual-asset activities increasingly sit within the SFC's perimeter; STABO is following the evolving virtual-asset regime around dealing, custody, advisory, and asset management closely and intends to prepare for those licensing regimes as they come into effect (Source: STABO).

Triple-A also supports treasury use cases where businesses collect funds in one market and move liquidity to another entity or regional headquarters. For APAC companies operating across multiple countries, this can mean collecting revenue locally and moving it to a treasury hub such as Singapore and Hong Kong using stablecoin rails, instead of relying only on slower correspondent banking routes. Triple-A handles the local currency and stablecoin conversion, cross-border movement and compliance layer, allowing businesses to consolidate liquidity across markets without building their own digital-asset infrastructure (Source: Triple-A).

> Stablecoins in B2B are past the proof-of-concept stage. The next phase is not about creating more protocols, but making regulated digital money genuinely useful to businesses and recognised as part of mainstream financial infrastructure. **STABO is tackling the integration challenge: connecting on-chain settlement with banking, payments, liquidity and treasury workflows.**
>
> **ARNOUD STAR BUSMANN,**
> ADVISOR TO STABO AND FORMER CEO
> OF A MICAR-REGULATED STABLECOIN ISSUER

STABO is addressing one of the most important barriers to digital asset adoption: transforming on-chain instruments into trusted infrastructure for real business payments.

As a professional and valued partner, STABO pairs strong execution with a disciplined approach to regulatory compliance and banking infrastructure built into its foundation.

This allows STABO to be uniquely positioned as a key bridge to the global financial system.

Zihang Ding,
Senior Head of Operations, Green Link Digital Bank

Regulated infrastructure and hybrid-rail settlement

Movantis operates a regulated network purpose-built for the US–LatAm corridor, with more than 60 licences across the Americas, **90,000+ payout locations, and 50+ money transfer operator relationships**, built over two decades of operating in Latin America (Source: Movantis). The company facilitates the movement of more than $63 billion annually and joined the Circle Payments Network on 13 April 2026, adding USDC settlement to its multi-rail infrastructure (Source: PR Newswire).

Movantis does not yet generate material volume on APAC corridors through stablecoin rails; current flows into APAC destinations settle through traditional fiat rails and its MTO network. Its APAC entry is planned predominantly through USDC settlement into the Philippines, India, Indonesia, and Africa, using the same hybrid model it operates in Latin America: fiat and stablecoin rails working together, with the optimal path chosen per transaction.

In markets where local partners accept USDC settlement, this can significantly compress the time to first transaction without the pre-funding requirements that make traditional expansion capital-intensive (Source: Movantis). **Movantis enters APAC as the regulated infrastructure on the US-origin end of the corridor**, the largest single remittance source for both the Philippines and India, bringing the same hybrid model that drives its LatAm operations.

Global payouts: paying businesses and individuals across fragmented markets

For companies operating across APAC, demand for stablecoin payouts is growing particularly fast in markets where access to US dollars is limited, local currencies are volatile, and traditional cross-border payment rails are costly or unreliable. Marketplaces, digital platforms, employers and other businesses increasingly use stablecoins to pay suppliers, contractors, creators, sellers and other recipients across multiple countries.

Triple-A enables businesses to fund payouts in local currency and deliver funds to recipients in stablecoins, while handling the conversion, compliance and payout infrastructure in between. This allows businesses to reach recipients across markets without managing wallets, blockchain infrastructure or digital-asset compliance themselves.

In APAC, the use case is particularly relevant for regional platforms and global businesses paying recipients across Southeast Asia and other emerging markets. Stablecoin payouts can give recipients access to digital dollars directly, often within minutes and outside traditional banking hours. (Source: Triple-A)

“**Your postcode should not determine how quickly you get paid or whether you can access dollars. Stablecoin payouts remove that constraint. At Triple-A, we use the same infrastructure ourselves that we provide to businesses paying people across borders.”** says Eric Barbier, CEO, Triple-A

5

Corridor Analysis

Corridor Analysis

Intra-APAC: SG ↔ HK ↔ JP and TW ↔ JP ↔ KR

Flow types: trade settlement, institutional treasury, supplier payments, merchant acceptance.

Volume intensity: Singapore, Hong Kong, and Japan together originate the overwhelming majority of Asia's $245 billion in genuine stablecoin payments (Source: McKinsey & Company).

Cost benchmark: A cross-border B2B payment between Taiwan, Japan, and Korea typically routes through correspondent banking with two to five days of settlement time and fees accumulating at each intermediary and FX hop. The after-state on stablecoin rails is same-day (T+0) settlement, FX conversion in one step, and a complete audit record mapping to ERP entries, so reconciliation that once took days of manual matching is produced automatically as part of settlement (Source: Capital Layer, industry aggregate).

Regulatory context: This is the only corridor cluster in the world where three regulated regimes sit side by side, plus Taiwan's passed statute. The glue for 2026–27 is MAS's proposed recognition of foreign-issued stablecoins, Hong Kong's licensed HKD coins, and Japan's trust-type electronic payment instruments. Corridors are built bank by bank, not rail by rail: a corridor becomes real when a regulated institution on each end can operate it (Source: Capital Layer).

Current friction: No passporting. Local-currency coins remain tiny relative to USDT and USDC. Off-ramps and FX remain the expensive edge.

$245B of Asia's genuine stablecoin payments, overwhelmingly originated by Singapore, Hong Kong, and Japan.

A CROSS BORDER B2B PAYMENT, BEFORE AND AFTER

CORRESPONDENT BANKING	→	STABLECOIN RAILS
2 to 5 days settlement time, with fees accumulating at each intermediary and FX hop.		Same day (T+0) settlement, FX conversion in one step, and a complete audit record mapping to ERP entries.

APAC–US

Flow types: outbound e-commerce receipts, inbound remittances, treasury.

Context: The United States is the largest single remittance source for both the Philippines, at 39.7% of 2025 cash remittances (Source: BusinessWorld), and India, at 27.7% of total remittances (Source: Finnovate). Dollar stablecoins remain the settlement asset.

Trade context: The AI build-out has also made this a hardware corridor. Taiwan's exports to the United States reached US$198.3 billion in 2025, up 78% and 30.9% of the total, making the US Taiwan's largest export market for the first time in 26 years (Source: United Daily News, 16 May 2026, citing Ministry of Finance data); computers and servers alone accounted for US$145.8 billion of that, more than double 2024 (Source: Tom's Hardware, 23 February 2026, citing Taiwan International Trade Administration data).

The corridor advantage: On a US-to-Philippines or US-to-India lane, stablecoin settlement through networks such as the Circle Payments Network operates with no batch windows, banking hours, or holiday closures, so a transaction initiated in Los Angeles at 10 p.m. can reach the interbank settlement point in Manila or Mumbai in the same session rather than the next business day.

On traditional fiat rails, interbank settlement typically takes one to three business days depending on the depth of the correspondent chain. Beyond settlement speed, stablecoin rails eliminate the pre-funding requirements that traditional correspondent banking imposes, freeing working capital that would otherwise be held idle across multiple destination accounts simultaneously (Source: Movantis).

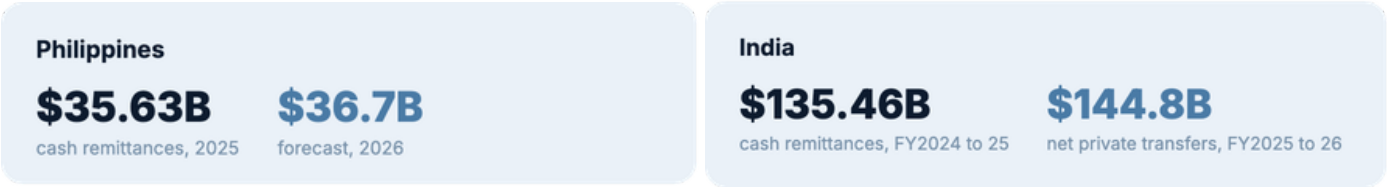
APAC–Middle East

Flow types: Gulf worker remittances, trade, treasury.

Context: Saudi Arabia and the UAE together accounted for 11.2% of Philippine cash remittances in 2025 (Source: BusinessWorld), and nearly half of all Indian migrants are employed in Gulf countries (Source: INDIA New England News). On the merchant and B2B side, Triple-A's APAC-to-MENA flows rose 604% in 2025 (Source: Triple-A), the fastest-growing corridor in its network.

High-volume remittance lanes: US/Gulf → Philippines, India, Indonesia

Philippines: $35.63 billion in cash remittances in 2025, forecast to reach $36.7 billion in 2026. The central bank notes that the US share is partly inflated by money transfer centres' use of US-based correspondent banks, a reminder that the correspondent layer distorts even the statistics (Source: Manila Bulletin).
India: $135.46 billion in FY2024–25 and $144.8 billion in net private transfers in FY2025–26 (Source: The Tribune).
Indonesia: Among the region's strongest grassroots adoption markets, with stablecoin usage extending into P2P transfers and remote-work income (Source: Triple-A).



Cost benchmark: Legacy pricing remains well above the 3% SDG target, with the International MTO Index at 5.52% (Source: World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide, Q3 2025).

On a Gulf-to-Philippines or Gulf-to-India lane, the time zone difference alone adds a full business day of delay on virtually every traditional payment. Stablecoin settlement eliminates that constraint entirely, compressing the interbank leg significantly. The last mile into a local beneficiary account or cash point continues to run on regulated local rails; stablecoin settlement does not replace that, and the efficiency gains sit on the institutional interbank leg (Source: Movantis).

Through 2027, stablecoins will complement traditional rails in every corridor we enter, including APAC. The institutions that win won't pick a side.

They'll route each transaction through whichever rail is optimal, under a consistent regulatory framework across the corridor.

We built that model in LatAm.
That's what we're taking to Asia.

Gustavo Ruiz,
Chairman & CEO, Movantis

6

Key Sectors in APAC Most in Need of Stablecoins

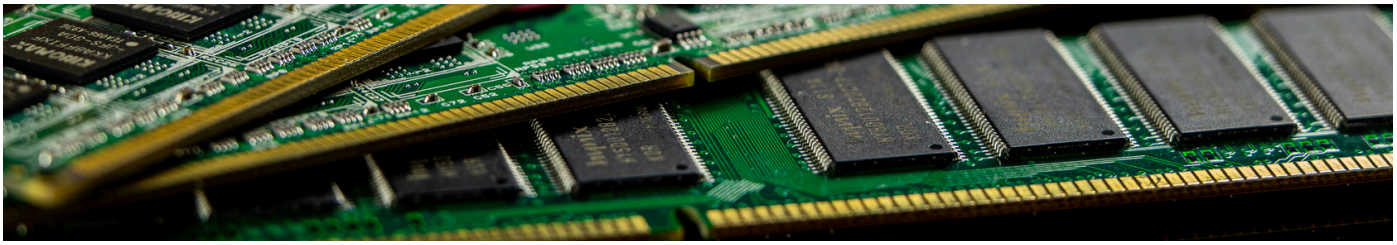
Key Sectors in APAC Most in Need of Stablecoins

Supply chains and trade settlement

B2B payments account for roughly 60% of genuine stablecoin payment volume globally, driven by supply chain payments, cross-border supplier settlements, and treasury liquidity management (Source: McKinsey & Company). In APAC's **hardware** corridors, a single shipment can carry seven-figure invoices, and the working capital locked in transit for days is the heavier cost (Source: Capital Layer, industry aggregate).

The largest and fastest-growing of these flows is the **AI hardware supply chain**. Taiwan produces more than 90% of the world's advanced AI chips (Source: U.S. International Trade Administration, 2024), and Taiwanese manufacturers assemble the majority of the world's AI servers. Global AI server shipments are forecast at about 2.8 million units in 2026, up 31% year on year (Source: TrendForce, August 2026), and global data centre capital expenditure is forecast to pass US$1 trillion in 2026 (Source: Dell'Oro Group, 10 June 2026).

Nearly all of that hardware is paid for across borders on correspondent rails and local payment networks that were not built for seven-figure invoices moving weekly. **Taiwan's export-driven enterprises already face requests from overseas counterparties to transact in stablecoins**; until the Virtual Asset Service Act, their banks had no framework to receive those flows (Source: Capital Layer).



Remittances

The structural demand is proven: **India and the Philippines alone received more than $170 billion in their most recent reporting years.** Conversion is a licensing and cash-out problem, not a demand problem. The operators that win will be those with regulated settlement on both ends and a hybrid routing model that uses stablecoins where they are optimal and fiat rails where they are not (Source: Movantis).

> The structural demand for remittances into APAC is not in question. India and the Philippines alone received more than $170 billion last year.
>
> The problem is not getting people to send money. It is landing it compliantly, in local currency, at the point where the beneficiary can actually use it.
>
> **That is a licensing and infrastructure problem, and it is exactly what we built for LatAm.**
>
> **GUSTAVO RUIZ,**
> CHAIRMAN & CEO, MOVANTIS

Corporate treasury and FX optimisation

Liquidity management is the leading benefit driving institutional stablecoin adoption in Asia, cited by 41% of institutions, against 25% pointing to lower fees (Source: Fireblocks). **Programmable wallets allow treasury teams to schedule and automate transactions across time zones without manual intervention.** On a US-to-APAC corridor, this is particularly relevant: when a US treasury team is offline, APAC markets are open, and stablecoin rails operate 24/7 with no batch windows or banking hour constraints (Source: Movantis). JPYSC's trust-type structure, with no transaction cap, is explicitly aimed at corporate fund settlement (Source: Digital Today).

Cross-border e-commerce and digital commerce

Travel, **gaming**, and **e-commerce** are natural fits because they serve international customers and benefit from faster settlement, lower payment costs, and an additional payment method for customers who already hold stablecoins (Source: Triple-A). The strongest commercial case is reaching customers and payment corridors that were previously difficult or impossible to monetise (Source: STABO).

> The next phase of stablecoin adoption will be driven less by crypto enthusiasm and **more by payment economics**. For merchants, faster settlement, lower processing costs and the elimination of card-style chargebacks can materially change the economics of serving international customers.
>
> In APAC, where businesses operate across highly fragmented markets and some of the world's busiest cross-border corridors, that value proposition is particularly relevant. **When the payment rail solves a real commercial problem, adoption follows.**
>
> **ERIC BARBIER,**
> CEO, TRIPLE-A

Corporate treasury and FX optimisation

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7

Money That Works: What Traditional Finance Needs to Know

Money That Works:
What TradFi Needs to Know

Legacy correspondent banking vs stablecoin rails

Dimension	Correspondent banking	Stablecoin rails
Interbank settlement	1 to 3 business days; 2 to 5 days on multi hop corridors	Same session; local off ramp determines final timing
Operating hours	Banking hours, cut offs, multi jurisdiction holidays	24/7/365
Pre funding	Idle capital held in destination markets	Eliminated or significantly reduced on the interbank leg
FX	Multiple hops, fees at each	Single step conversion
Reconciliation	Days of manual matching	Audit record produced as part of settlement
Chargebacks	Card scheme disputes	None; replaced by wallet provenance and KYT risk
Cost	International MTO Index 5.52% on $200 remittances	Merchant payment costs up to 70% lower

Sources: Movantis; Capital Layer, industry aggregate; STABO; Triple-A; World Bank

What changes on the balance sheet

The most under-appreciated benefit is working capital. Traditional pre-funding requirements mean an institution must hold idle capital in destination markets before transactions can be initiated. Stablecoin settlement frees working capital that would otherwise be locked across multiple destination accounts simultaneously (Source: Movantis). For a treasurer, the question is not "is the fee lower" but "how much capital comes off the table."

What does not change

The last mile still runs on regulated local rails. Everything downstream of the interbank leg still runs on the receiving market's infrastructure. Stablecoins do not eliminate payment risk; they change its nature. Card-scheme chargebacks disappear, but wallet provenance, tainted funds, and KYT obligations appear in their place (Source: STABO).

Practical entry points by jurisdiction

Singapore: Work with MAS Major Payment Institution licensees for acceptance and payouts today; watch the October 2026 consultation outcome for foreign-coin recognition.
Hong Kong: Institutional access to HKDAP via authorised distributors now; HSBC's coin and retail access expected late 2026. TCSP structures available for trust and segregation arrangements.
Japan: JPYSC for institutional yen settlement without the ¥1 million cap; JPYC for retail-scale flows; megabank coin expected by March 2027.
Taiwan: Banks are in proof-of-concept mode ahead of a Q1 2027 commencement at the earliest; corporates should begin operational readiness now.
Korea and Australia: Monitor; no live domestic stablecoin regime yet.

The routing principle

The institutions adopting fastest are not replacing fiat rails. They are adding a second rail and routing each transaction through whichever is optimal under a consistent regulatory framework across the corridor (Source: Movantis). The card sits alongside the existing card programme (Source: Reap); the stablecoin leg sits alongside the correspondent leg. Treat stablecoins as a new settlement option inside an existing treasury stack, not as a migration.

8

Outlook 2026–2027

Outlook 2026–2027

Which licences clear next

Singapore: MAS's consultation closes 16 October 2026; the resulting legislation is the piece that can open foreign and multi-currency recognition (Source: Monetary Authority of Singapore).

APAC regulatory timeline ahead

Singapore
MAS's consultation closes 16 October 2026; the resulting legislation is the piece that can open foreign and multi currency recognition.

Hong Kong
A second batch of issuer licences after the two bank first wave; HSBC's HKD coin and HKDAP retail access in late 2026.

Japan
Megabank co issued yen stablecoin by March 2027.

Taiwan
Act and subordinate regulations effective Q1 2027 at the earliest, with 12 months for existing firms to apply and 21 months to reach approval.

South Korea
Digital Asset Basic Act targeted for passage in the second half of 2026, contingent on resolving the bank ownership dispute.

Australia
Payments and stored value facility framework for stablecoins still moving alongside the Digital Assets Framework.

Where multi-currency settlement consolidates

USD stablecoins remain the volume layer; the market is roughly **99.5% dollar-denominated** (Source: Reap). HKD and JPY coins are bank-grade but will remain small until trade treasuries adopt them. MAS's joint-issuance and foreign-recognition proposals are the only official APAC path toward a multi-currency labelled coin. Expect settlement to consolidate around USDC and USDT for cross-border legs, with local-currency coins handling the domestic off-ramp.

The regulatory arbitrage that closes

Three arbitrages narrowed in 2026–27:

1. The **yield ban** becomes universal: Singapore's proposal joins Hong Kong, Taiwan, and Japan in prohibiting interest to holders.
2. Singapore's Singapore-only **issuance rule** is being relaxed toward joint and foreign recognition.
3. **Japan's ¥1 million** cap no longer binds trust-type coins.

What remains open is the absence of passporting, and that is the arbitrage that will define which hub wins.

The forward view: agentic payments and B2B automation

The next category of payment volume will not come from replacing legacy flows. It will come from flows that did not exist before. **Stablecoins are emerging as a preferred infrastructure layer for agentic AI use cases**, which could create entirely new categories of payments over time (Source: Reap).

Corporate card and cross-border volumes are likely to shift first toward trade corridors where friction is highest, particularly import-export flows between global and emerging markets that remain dependent on legacy rails. The biggest remaining friction is not technology. It is the fragmented divide between fiat-based workflows and stablecoin-based rails (Source: Reap), and the operators who close that divide inside existing bank and ERP systems will decide who captures the volume.

The paying side of agentic commerce is getting most of the attention.

The receiving side is where banks come in. A company that sells compute, models, or AI services is a corporate client of its bank. Its customers will increasingly pay in stablecoins, at any hour, from systems rather than people, and that revenue has to be received, booked, reconciled, and settled through the bank like any other receivable.

The pull is already visible at the regulator: Taiwan's Financial Supervisory Commission says banks are studying stablecoin exchange and transfer services to meet the cross-border payment needs of their supply-chain clients (Source: United Daily News, 19 August 2026).

Capital Layer builds the institutional infrastructure that lets a bank open that channel, with keys held in the bank's own environment and approvals tied to the bank's existing dual control and segregation of duties (Source: Capital Layer).

Three ways of getting paid are arriving at different speeds. Companies already bill for AI by usage. Soon, machines will earn money for the company that owns them. Further out, one company's systems will pay another company's systems directly.

Across all three, the same things stay true, and they are what banks should hold onto: the account always belongs to a company, that company decides how much can be spent, and its bank is the one that releases the money.

No machine ever gets an account of its own. Get those three things right, and which rail the money travels on becomes a detail.

JUSTIN WANG,
CEO, CAPITAL LAYER

What's changing with agentic payments isn't just who initiates a transaction, it's what a payment needs to be able to do.

An agent transacting on someone's behalf needs rails that are programmable by default, that can enforce spend limits, verify counterparties, and settle instantly, all without a human in the loop for every step. Card networks and legacy payment infrastructure weren't built for that kind of autonomy.

Stablecoins fit naturally here because they give us a settlement layer that's always on and inherently programmable. We can attach rules, permissions, and identity checks directly to the movement of funds, rather than bolting them on after the fact. That's the difference between an agent that can transact and one that can transact safely at scale.

We're already seeing early demand from businesses that want their agents handling procurement, vendor payments, and treasury operations.

The question isn't whether agentic payments end up on stablecoin rails, it's how quickly the tooling around identity, compliance, and control catches up.

Anna Chiu,
Head of Agentic Payments, Reap

Our Partners

Our Partners

CAPITAL LAYER
Asia's digital asset orchestration layer, coordinating stablecoin settlement, custody and compliance between the region's banks, enterprises and infrastructure providers.

MOVANTIS
Regulated financial infrastructure for cross-border value movement across the Americas and beyond, combining payments, remittances, FX, wallet infrastructure, card issuing, and stablecoin settlement through one integration. $63B+ in annual volume. Circle Payments Network member.

REAP
Hong Kong-based payments infrastructure that lets businesses spend, send and settle in stablecoins through cards and API-driven money movement.

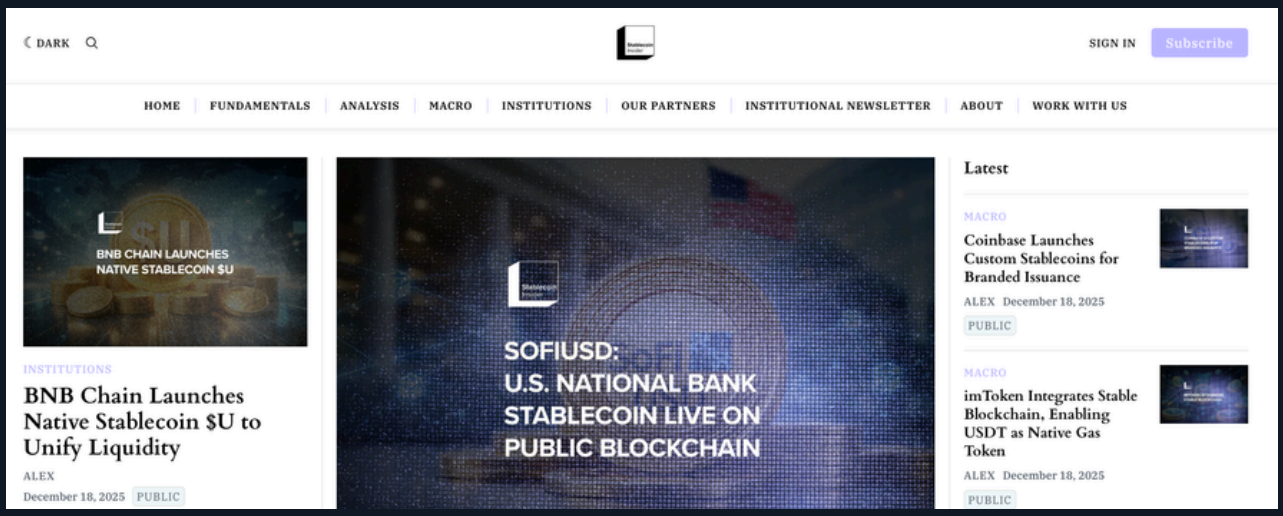
STABO
A Hong Kong-licensed clearing layer that connects banking rails and stablecoin liquidity so businesses can accept, convert and settle fiat and stablecoins in one flow.

TRIPLE-A
A global payment institution licensed across Singapore, Europe and the United States, enabling businesses to accept and make stablecoin payments with settlement in local currencies.

About Stablecoin Insider

Stablecoin Insider is the leading source for news, data, and expert insights on stablecoins and the future of blockchain-based finance. As global interest in stable digital currencies accelerates, we deliver in-depth, independent reporting on the technologies, platforms, policies, and real-world use cases driving stablecoin adoption worldwide.

Stablecoin Insider works closely with companies across the stablecoin and digital payments stack to help them increase visibility, credibility, and discoverability. On a journey to be the go-to knowledge hub for professionals in the stablecoin space serving the space through articles, reports, interviews, collaborations, and events.



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Stablecoin Insider
Q3 | September 2026

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